

National University Manila
College of Education, Arts, and Sciences
Bachelor of Secondary Education Department

Worksheet in Literary Criticism (Structuralism)

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Write your Analysis here:

In structuralism, a signifier is a word or image, while the signification is the meaning behind it. In simple terms, it's how something is named and what idea it represents. These signs work together to shape how we understand a story.

In *Sweet Summer*, one important sign is “fudge,” which is used to describe Sara. The signifier is fudge, a dark and simple kind of candy. Its signification is how Sara is seen—plain, less attractive, and not as special compared to others. This becomes more obvious when we compare her to girls labeled as “éclair” or “Cloud 9,” which suggest beauty, lightness, and desirability. Because of these labels, Sara is placed at a lower level in their group.

This sign connects to the Candy Club, where the girls use sweets to define each other. These are not just cute names—they reflect how they judge worth based on appearance. When Frederick notices Sara and spends time with her, the meaning of “fudge” briefly changes. She feels seen and valued. But when he leaves her, influenced by his older brother, Sara goes back to being “just fudge.” This shows that meaning depends on how others treat you.

Overall, these signs reveal the deeper message of the story. The contrast between fudge and the more “attractive” sweets shows unfair beauty standards and social hierarchy. It also highlights how Sara’s happiness is temporary and dependent on others’ validation. Through signifier and signification, we see that the story is really about how identity and self-worth are shaped by labels and social perception.

Lesson Plan - ENGLISH 10

Objectives

At the end of the 50-minute lesson, the students must be able to

- Infer the meaning of unfamiliar words and expressions in *Sweet Summer* using context clues and structuralist interpretation of signifier and signification;
- Annotate significant words, phrases, and textual clues in *Sweet Summer*; and
- Show appreciation for how context clues and symbolic meanings help deepen understanding of the story’s themes and messages.

Subject Matter

Topic: Context clues

Materials: Powerpoint Presentation, Instructional Materials, Laptop

Reeference: https://www.scribd.com/document/507598121/Sweet-Summer-by-Cyan-Abad-Jugo#google_vignette

Values Infused: Encourages students to be interested in discovering meanings of unfamiliar words and symbols.

Procedure

Routine Activities

- Prayer
- Greetings
- Attendance
- Classroom Management

Review

- What is a sentence?
- What are the parts of a sentence?
- Can you give an example of a simple sentence?

Motivation

Game title: *What Does It Mean?*

Instruction: The teacher will present a line from Sweet Summer on the board:

"Her heart leapt as if she had been kissed."

- Students will read the sentence and use the surrounding context to infer its meaning. After a short think time, they will answer the question, *"What does this line suggest about Sara's feelings?"* The teacher will then guide them to conclude that it shows excitement or affection, introducing the use of context clues.

Lesson Proper

Context Clues - Context clues are words or phrases found in a sentence or paragraph that help you understand the meaning of an unfamiliar word.

Example:

"His lemony breath touched her face, and her heart leapt as if she had been kissed."

Context Clues: "lemony breath," "heart leapt," and "as if she had been kissed"

Inferred Meaning: "heart leapt" means she felt sudden excitement or strong emotion (like happiness or attraction)

In simple terms, they are hints from the surrounding text that help you figure out what a word means without using a dictionary.

1. **Signifier** - The signifier is the word, phrase, or expression you see or read in the text.

Example:

- The phrase "heart leapt" → this is the signifier

2. **Signification** - The signification is the meaning or idea that comes to your mind when you read the word or phrase.

Example word: *"heart leapt"*

- Signification: feeling excited, nervous, or experiencing a sudden emotional reaction (like liking someone).

Application

Instruction: The class will be divided into 4 groups. Each group will be given a short excerpt from Sweet Summer. Students will read the text and annotate it by underlining or highlighting significant words, phrases, and context clues. Then, they will write their inferred meanings beside the text.

After annotating, each group will choose one example to present and explain how the context helped them understand the meaning.

Short excerpts:

1. “The Candy Club were all twelve that summer... savoring macaroons, Halls honey-lemon, and Cloud 9. The older boys had begun to hover about like bees, ogling them like treats...”
2. “The boy looked up and considered the three girls, none of them looking. The dog ignored them, and lapped at the water...”
3. “The nut-brown fudge regarded herself with surprise. A boy... was talking, walking with her!”
4. “When he stood up, his lemony breath touched her face, and her heart leapt as if she had been kissed.”

Generalization

1. When you annotated words and phrases, how did context clues help you identify their meanings?
2. How did those meanings lead you to understand what the words or images represent beyond their literal meaning?
3. Why is it important to connect the signifier and the signified when interpreting a story?

Evaluation

- Instruction: Complete the table by identifying the literal meaning (signifier) and the deeper meaning (signified) of each word or phrase.

Passage:

“The Candy Club were all twelve that summer... The older boys had begun to hover about like bees, ogling them like treats— but only the two creamy long-legged eclairs, not the nut-brown fudge in a housedress melting in the sun.”

Signifier (word/image)	Literal Meaning (What it is)	Signified (What it represents)
1. bees		
2. eclairs		
3. nut-brown fudge		

Assignment

Instruction: Choose 3 important words from Sweet Summer. Then answer the guide questions below for each one.

For each word you choose, write:

1. Signifier – the word or image from the story
2. Literal meaning – what it literally refers to
3. Inferred meaning (using context clues) – what you think it means based on how it is used in the story
4. Signified (deeper meaning) – what it represents symbolically or suggests about the story's message